

High-chance portions — hist-modern

Combined original study articles for this topic's highest-probability PYQ themes.

Constitutional Acts & Congress Sessions

~48% · Charter/Councils Acts · GOI Act 1919/1935 · INC sessions & presidents

Regulating Acts to 1935 + landmark INC sessions — highest-frequency Modern India drill.

Why UPSC asks this

Acts and sessions yield date–provision–personality triples ideal for Prelims.

Acts as a spine

Build a one-page timeline: Company regulation (1773, 1784 Pitt's India Act), Charter Acts (1833/1853), 1858 transfer to Crown, Indian Councils Acts, 1909 separate electorates flashpoint, 1919 dyarchy in provinces, 1935 provincial autonomy and federal scheme (partly unimplemented). For each, remember 1–2 operative features only — depth beats trivia sprawl.

Congress sessions that matter

Match year–place–resolution: 1885 Bombay founding; 1907 Surat split (Extremists/Moderates); 1916 Lucknow Pact; 1920 Nagpur non-cooperation organisational shifts; 1929 Lahore Purna Swaraj; 1931 Karachi resolution on fundamental rights/national economic plan themes. Presidents and firsts (woman president, etc.) appear in matching lists.

Exam tactic

When stuck, eliminate anachronisms (Purna Swaraj before 1929) and mix-ups between 1919 dyarchy vs 1935 autonomy.

Must remember

- 1773 Regulating; 1833 centralisation; 1858 Crown; 1909 Morley–Minto; 1919 Montagu–Chelmsford; 1935 provincial autonomy
- 1905 Swadeshi context; 1907 Surat split; 1916 Lucknow Pact; 1929 Lahore Purna Swaraj

National & Gandhian Mass Movements

~46% · Non-Cooperation · Civil Disobedience/Salt · Quit India · Revolutionary strand

Swadeshi to Quit India — phases, methods, social base and why questions repeat.

Why UPSC asks this

Movement chronology and method differences are perennial discriminators.

Phase logic

Study nationalism as shifting strategies: Moderates' petition politics; Extremists' Swadeshi; Gandhian mass satyagraha; revolutionary terrorism; Left and peasant/worker strands; Subhas/INA. UPSC tests whether you can place a method in the right decade.

Gandhian experiments

Champaran (indigo), Kheda (revenue), Ahmedabad (mill workers) precede all-India NCM. Non-Cooperation paired with Khilafat; Chauri Chaura halted the movement. Civil Disobedience opened with Dandi; Round Table Conferences and Gandhi–Irwin Pact are checkpoint facts. Quit India (1942) under “Do or Die” amid wartime repression — leaders imprisoned, spontaneous parallel activity.

Beyond Gandhi

Keep bullets on Bhagat Singh/HSRA, Surya Sen, women in movements, and peasant/tribal uprisings as complementary PYQ pools.

Must remember

- 1919–22 NCM + Khilafat; 1930 Salt March/CDM; 1942 Quit India
- Champaran, Kheda, Ahmedabad — early satyagrahas
- INA & INA trials — later nationalist emotion

Socio-Religious Reform Movements

~32% · Reform organisations · Women reformers · Education & social laws

Brahmo, Arya, Aligarh, Ramakrishna Mission — reformers and programmes.

Why UPSC asks this

Organisation–founder–idea matching is a stable Modern India sub-theme.

Reform map

Classify movements by region and emphasis: Bengal Renaissance/Brahmo; Maharashtra social radicals; Arya Samaj in Punjab/north; Aligarh modernism among Muslims; Singh Sabha; Parsi and other community reforms. Note press, schools, and legal campaigns against sati/child marriage as linked arenas.

Exam focus

Founder !" organisation !" one signature idea. Women reformers increasingly appear — prepare a short list.

Must remember

- Raja Rammohan Roy — Brahmo; Dayananda — Arya Samaj/Shuddhi; Syed Ahmed Khan — Aligarh
- Jyotiba Phule, Savitribai, Pandita Ramabai, Tarabai Shinde